

Compound time signatures

In compound time signatures, the beat is subdivided into three rather than two, and is therefore always a dotted note. For example, the time signature 3/4 and 6/8 both contain six eighth notes in a measure, but 3/4 denotes three quarter notes, while 6/8 denotes two dotted quarter notes. Shown below are more such compound time signatures.



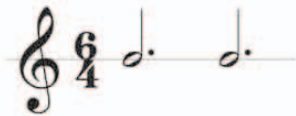
6/8 time signature



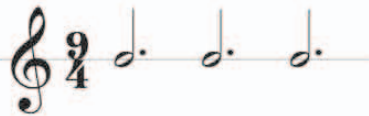
9/8 time signature



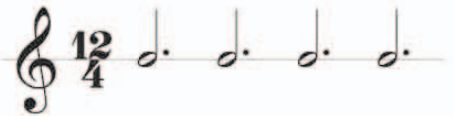
12/8 time signature



6/4 time signature



9/4 time signature



12/4 time signature



6/16 time signature



9/16 time signature



12/16 time signature

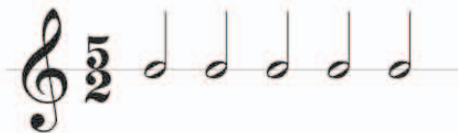
Irregular time signatures

Time signatures do not always have two, three, or four beats in a measure. Shown here are examples of some unusual or irregular time signatures. If the beat is an eighth or sixteenth note, the notes can be grouped to show where the strong beats are.



△ Calypso rhythm

In a calypso rhythm, the time signature is 4/4, but the beat is subdivided in an unusual way: 3 + 3 + 2. This rhythm is common in calypso, folk, and popular music.



5/2 time signature



7/4 time signature



11/8 time signature



13/16 time signature